

Wordpress.org hacked!

After attacking Wordpress.com, hackers have broken into Wordpress.org's code and plugin section, compromising security of the free CMS.

Siemens debuts hybrid aircraft

Siemens introduced the first serial hybrid electric aircraft at the Paris Air Show

Router test

N3 but has a USB port for media sharing. While simple looking, these routers have rather functional LED indicators on the front, but no buttons or switches of any sort, not even for WPS. The ZyXEL NGB-419N has a very different menu layout compared to the other ZyXEL router we tested. Also there is no setting for changing the protocol between B/G and N – this setting is not even visible. It also prompts for a new password the moment one enters the router firmware, though this isn't necessarily bad, rather it's a plus, because many people forget to change the default password, thereby leaving

But the router that just begs for attention with its rather unique broad antennae is the Buffalo WZR-HP-G300NH. These antennae will fold inwards to rest atop the router but when raised give the appearance of some space age device. They're not removable though this isn't an issue since they don't protrude when folded. Besides the AOSS security button (Air-station One touch Secure System), which is Buffalo's equivalent of WPS but is a little more secure owing to the creation and exchange of a 64-bit WEP key that is secret, unlike a predetermined key that WPS uses.

in our transfer tests, it suffered during video playback, where our 1080p copy of Avatar took up to 2 seconds longer to cache after we skipped through the file.

The most stable performer throughout the zones was the Buffalo WZR-HP-G300NH that managed over 1.5 megabytes per second in zone three and over 5 megabytes per second in zone one across both sequential and non-sequential transfers. The Netgear also performed well in zone one, but in zone two and three, it's clear that signal attenuation is killing its data transmission rate. The fastest overall router in this group was the ZyXEL NGB-419N.

But the fastest router was also a bit costlier at ₹4,400 than the cheapest one in this group, the SMC SMCWBR14S-N3 that offers 80 per cent of the performance at ₹2,950 – making it much better value for money, and the winner of our Best Buy award.

BETWEEN ₹5,001 AND ₹8,000: WHEN SPEED IS THE NEED

Routers within this price range typically boast of advanced features like USB ports for media streaming, and dual simultaneous band – a technique that creates two different wireless networks, on two different frequencies, typically 2.4 GHz and 5 GHz. This category was sparsely populated – 5 routers, two from TPLink – a company we've not seen before, and one each from ASUS, Linksys and Dlink.

Looks and features

Both TPLink routers are very attractive, with a piano white finish, black border on three sides and the brand name nicely embossed on the top. While the TL-MR3420 features a single USB port for 3G cards, the TL-WR1043ND has a more common media-streaming function off its USB port. The former is also smaller, and features two



SMC SMCWBR14S-N3

their networks vulnerable. The interface is radically different and each item under a menu is well laid out and the menu options quite self-explanatory. Externally, it is nice looking – a white coloured router with bright, large green indicator LEDs. There is a wireless off button on the rear, something other routers miss.

Performance

In zone one and zone two, the ZyXEL NGB-419N blows everything else out of the water. However, it dips in zone three, betraying a lack of signal strength and antenna coverage. While the Belkin Share outdoes its cheaper sibling, the Share in zone three

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